

PAULT DOCUMENTATION

User Guide

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User guide

Visual walkthrough placeholders

Use these placeholders until final UI screenshots are captured. The file names match the existing screenshot plan in docs/app-store/screenshot-capture.md.

Placeholder 1: main library overview

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/01-library-overview.png
- **Capture target:** Main window with sidebar filters, search, and a selected prompt in the detail pane.
- **What should be visible:** Recently Used / All Prompts / Archived filters, prompt list, editor area.

Placeholder 2: prompt detail editor

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/02-editor-detail.png
- **Capture target:** Prompt detail editor with realistic title/content and the inspector open.
- **What should be visible:** Inline editing, variables section (if prompt contains `{{variable}}`), tags/favorite/archive controls.

Placeholder 3: menu bar popover

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/03-menu-bar-popover.png
- **Capture target:** Menu bar mini library open with search/filter state.
- **What should be visible:** Favorites/All/Archived filter pills, prompt rows, quick actions.

Placeholder 4: global launcher

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/04-global-launcher.png
- **Capture target:** Hotkey launcher (Cmd+Shift+P) with query text and ranked results.
- **What should be visible:** Search field, highlighted selection, keyboard hint flow.

Placeholder 5: quick paste action

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/05-quick-paste.png
- **Capture target:** Action view after selecting a launcher result.
- **What should be visible:** Copy/Paste action buttons and selected prompt context.

Placeholder 6: favorites + archived state

- **Future image path:** docs/app-store/screenshots/06-favorites-archive.png
- **Capture target:** One view showing favorite and archived workflow states.
- **What should be visible:** A favorited prompt and archived-filter behavior.

Getting started

- Launch Pault to open the main window (sidebar + detail editor).
- On first launch, a short onboarding flow introduces main window, menu bar, and hotkey launcher.
- Use **Cmd+N** (or the + button) to create a new prompt.

Create a prompt

- Main window: click **+** or press **Cmd+N** to create a new prompt.
- Menu bar popover: click **New** to open the creation sheet.
- In the menu bar sheet, at least one of title/content is required to enable **Create**.
- In the main window flow, empty drafts are allowed and save as you edit.

Edit a prompt

- Select a prompt from the sidebar.
- Edit the title or content directly in the editor.
- Updates are saved after a short debounce.

Template variables

- Add placeholders in content using `{{variable_name}}` (letters, numbers, underscore).
- When placeholders exist, a **Variables** section appears below the editor.
- Fill variable values to generate a live resolved preview.
- Use **Clear** in the Variables section to reset all filled values for that prompt.
- Copy/paste actions resolve filled variables; unfilled variables remain as `{{variable_name}}`.

Tags

- Open the inspector (info button or **Cmd+I**).
- Add existing tags or create new ones with a color.
- Click a tag pill in the sidebar list to filter by that tag.

Favorites and archive

- Toggle favorite from the context menu or inspector.
- Archive prompts to remove them from the default list.
- Use the **Archived** filter to view archived prompts.

Search and filters

- Use the search field in the sidebar to match title, content, or tag name.
- Filters include **Recently Used**, **All Prompts**, and **Archived**.

Menu bar access

- Click the menu bar icon to open the mini library.
- Use filters: **Favorites**, **All**, **Archived**.
- Search, expand a prompt, and use **Copy**, **Paste**, **Favorite**, **Archive**, or **Delete**.
- Create a new prompt from the popover.

Global hotkey launcher

- Press **Cmd+Shift+P** to open the launcher from anywhere.
- Type to search, then press **Return** to perform the configured default action.
- Use **Up/Down** to move selection.

- Use **Cmd+1..Cmd+9** to instantly run the top nine results.
- If default action is **Show options**, choose **Copy** or **Paste** in the action view.
- The default action is configurable in Preferences: **Show options** (default), **Copy to clipboard**, or **Paste to app**.

Copy and paste feedback

- A floating toast notification confirms when a prompt has been copied to the clipboard.
- Delete actions require confirmation before removing a prompt.
- Paste actions use Accessibility APIs. If needed, macOS prompts for permission on first paste attempt.

Preferences

- Open **Settings** from the menu bar popover or the app menu.
- **Launch at login** toggles automatic startup.
- **Show dock icon** switches between accessory and regular app modes.
- **Default action** controls what happens when you select a prompt in the launcher: show options, copy to clipboard, or paste into the frontmost app.
- **Paste delay** controls the delay (in milliseconds) before simulating Cmd+V after copying.

Tips

- Use short titles for faster scanning in the sidebar and launcher.
- Add tags for long-term organization and favorites for quick access.
- Empty state messages guide you when no prompts match your search or filter.

FAQ

Why don't I see archived prompts?

- Archived prompts are hidden from the default list. Switch to **Archived** in the sidebar.

Why doesn't the hotkey work?

- Ensure Pault is running. If paste actions fail, macOS will automatically prompt for Accessibility permission. Grant access in **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Accessibility**.

Why do I still see {{variable}} after copying?

- That variable currently has an empty value in the Variables section. Fill it to resolve on copy/paste.

Can I export or import prompts?

- Not yet. Export/import is planned but not implemented in the current app target.